

STORYHOUR

Digital Storytelling Platform

Product + Technical Specification

BUILD DOCUMENT

This document is the working specification for the complete StoryHour redesign and rebuild, from an empty repository through production launch.

DOCUMENT	VALUE
Version	2.0
Status	Build specification / working baseline
Prepared	28 August 2026
Reference	storyhour.co.uk
Primary objective	Rebuild StoryHour as a story-led digital platform

Source note: Current-site facts in this document are based on the live StoryHourGlobal website and its current Ramayana product pages.

01 / What we are building

StoryHour should not be rebuilt as a prettier version of the current shop. The new product should make the story itself the centre of the experience.

The existing site already has the foundations: Indian mythology, culture and history; audiobooks; skits and puppet storytelling; a storyteller-led brand; and current Ramayana audio products in Hindi, English and Telugu. [cite?turn0view0?](#)

PRODUCT NORTH STAR

A visitor should be able to arrive with no prior knowledge of StoryHour, understand what it stands for within seconds, discover a story, hear it, understand why it matters, and move naturally into the next experience.

The shift

TODAY	NEW PRODUCT
Store-led	Story-led
Product cards	Story discovery
Basic product detail	Editorial story experience
Listen / download CTA	Persistent, first-class audio
Marketing sections	Connected content system
Static catalogue	Scalable story library
Website as destination	Website as the digital home of StoryHour

02 / Current product baseline

The current homepage presents the positioning “Stories That Live Beyond Time” and describes StoryHour as bringing Indian mythology, culture and history to life through audiobooks, skits and puppet storytelling. It also identifies children, parents, adults and educators as audiences and highlights an audio-first experience, expressive narration, performance and cultural preservation. [cite?turn0search0?turn0view0?](#)

CURRENT AREA	OBSERVED BASELINE
Home	Hero, audiobook products, value propositions, storyteller section, signature Ramayana section.
Audiobooks	Ramayan Hindi, Ramayana English, Ramayanam Telugu are currently listed.
Commerce	Current product pages expose price, quantity, Add to cart and product description.
Storyteller	Brand story and performance background are part of the homepage.
Performance	Skits and puppet shows are explicitly referenced.
Languages	Hindi, English and Telugu products are currently visible.

IMPORTANT

Current prices, checkout behaviour, shipping language and platform implementation are reference facts only. They must be verified before engineering locks the commerce architecture. The current site shows \$74.99 Hindi, \$84.99 English and \$64.99 Telugu, with product pages also displaying “Free Shipping.”

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03 / Product principles

Story before interface

Every major screen should answer: what story or human experience is this helping the visitor reach?

Audio is a product surface

Listening cannot be buried behind a download button.

Culture without cliché

Use cultural references deliberately. Avoid generic decorative “Indian” styling.

Editorial over catalogue

Typography, pacing, imagery and copy should feel closer to a premium editorial experience than a conventional shop.

Human voice

The storyteller and the performance history are part of the product identity.

Global by default

The experience should work naturally for audiences in India, the UK and elsewhere.

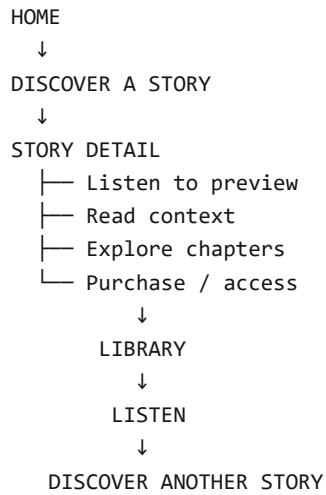
Fast by default

Motion and media are allowed to be rich; they are not allowed to make the product sluggish.

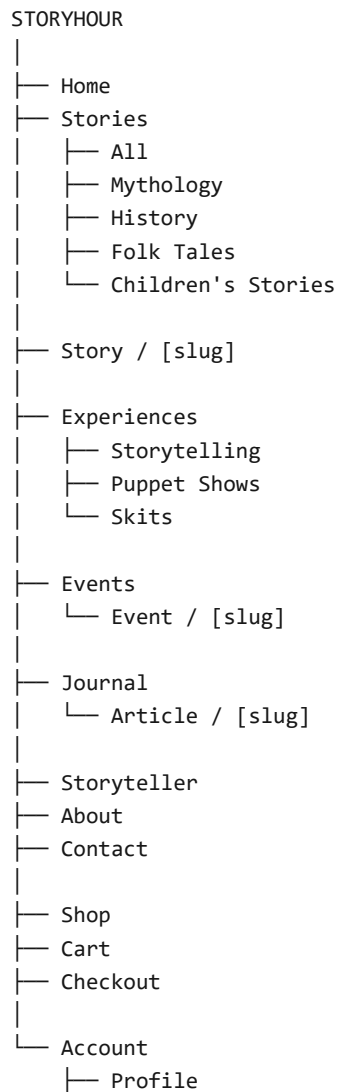
04 / Audience & journeys

USER	WHAT THEY NEED	PRIMARY JOURNEY
Curious visitor	Understand StoryHour quickly.	Home → Story → Preview → Explore
Listener	Find something worth hearing.	Stories → Filter/Search → Story → Listen
Customer	Buy and access content.	Story → Purchase → Library → Listen
Parent / family	Find suitable cultural stories.	Stories → Language/Age/Theme → Story → Listen
Educator	Discover stories and context.	Stories/Journal → Story → Context / Enquiry
Event organiser	Understand live offerings.	Experiences → Event → Enquiry
Content manager	Publish without developer involvement.	Admin → Content → Review → Publish

Core visitor flow



05 / Information architecture



- └ Orders
- └ Library

ROUTING RULE

Final routes may change during UX design. Once approved, routes must be treated as a product contract because SEO, analytics, redirects and external links depend on them.

06 / Page blueprints

Home

The homepage is an entry into the world of StoryHour, not a list of everything the business does.

SECTION	JOB	NOTES
Hero	Establish the world and proposition.	Strong visual + concise message + one primary discovery action.
Featured story	Give the visitor an immediate story to enter.	Artwork, title, short premise, listen/explore action.
Story library preview	Show breadth.	Do not overload; lead to Stories.
Audio moment	Demonstrate the quality of narration.	Short, deliberate preview.
Why StoryHour	Explain the difference.	Culture, performance, preservation, accessibility.
Storyteller	Humanise the brand.	Lead to full Storyteller page.
Experiences	Connect digital stories to live performance.	Storytelling, puppet shows, skits.
Flagship Ramayana	Anchor the catalogue.	Use the existing signature audiobook as the current flagship.
Footer	Navigation, contact, legal, social and commerce links.	Keep useful, not enormous.

Stories

A discovery interface for the growing catalogue.

Required: search, category filtering, language filtering, story cards, pagination or infinite loading, loading state, empty state and clear access/listening state.

Story detail

This is the most important new template.

AREA	REQUIREMENT
Hero	Artwork, title, short premise and primary listen/access action.
Story metadata	Language, narrator, duration and other confirmed metadata.
Audio	Preview/full player, progress and chapter navigation.

Description	Readable editorial synopsis.
Context	Optional cultural/historical context managed by CMS.
Purchase	Clear commercial state and CTA.
Related	Related stories by theme/category/language.

Experiences / Events

Present the live side of StoryHour with enough detail to understand what is offered and how to enquire.
Booking complexity is a client decision.

Journal

Editorial content that deepens the stories and gives the site a reason to be revisited. Articles should support SEO and link naturally back to stories.

Storyteller

The current site already tells a story about the person behind StoryHour and performance across India and the UK. The rebuild should turn this into a deliberate brand page rather than another homepage block.

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07 / Story data model

```

Story
  id
  title
  slug
  shortDescription
  longDescription
  coverImage
  heroMedia
  status
  languages[]
  categories[]
  themes[]
  narrator
  duration
  ageGroup?
  culturalContext?
  transcript?
  productId?
  featured
  seoTitle
  seoDescription
  createdAt
  updatedAt

```

```

Chapter
  id

```

```

storyId
title
order
startTime
duration
audioAsset
previewAvailable

```

```

AudioAsset
  id
  storyId
  chapterId?
  storageKey
  duration
  mimeType
  accessType
  createdAt

```

The UI must consume this data through a content/API layer. Stories, categories and languages must not be hard-coded into components.

08 / Audio experience

Audio is the part of the product that most directly differentiates StoryHour from a normal cultural content site.

CONTROL	BEHAVIOUR
Play / pause	Immediate response with visible state.
Seek	Touch and mouse friendly; keyboard accessible.
Progress	Show current position and total duration.
Chapter	Jump between chapters without losing context.
Preview	Public preview where configured.
Access	Full audio only when the user has the required entitlement.
Resume	Restore progress where supported and appropriate.
Error	Explain failure and provide a retry path.
Mobile	Controls must remain usable without zooming or precision tapping.

SECURITY

Hiding an audio URL in the UI is not access control. Protected audio must be delivered through an appropriate server/provider mechanism.

09 / Commerce

The current site is already using a cart-based product flow, so the rebuild must make a deliberate choice between retaining that commerce backend and replacing it. [cite2turn0view0](#)

DECISION	STATUS
Commerce platform	CLIENT DECISION
Payment provider	CLIENT DECISION
Currency / target markets	CLIENT DECISION
Physical shipping	CLIENT DECISION
Digital download vs streaming	CLIENT DECISION
Customer accounts	CLIENT DECISION
Refund / cancellation rules	CLIENT DECISION

Target purchase flow

STORY
 ↓
 SELECT ACCESS / PURCHASE
 ↓
 CART
 ↓
 CHECKOUT
 ↓
 PAYMENT
 ↓
 ORDER CONFIRMATION
 ↓
 LIBRARY / DOWNLOAD / STREAM

DO NOT GUESS

The existing site displays dollar pricing and “Free Shipping” on current audiobook products. Confirm whether these are still correct before building the new checkout, tax, fulfilment or customer-account model. [?cite?turn0search1?turn0search2?](#)

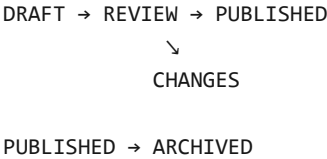
10 / CMS & administration

A new story should be publishable by the content team without a code deployment.

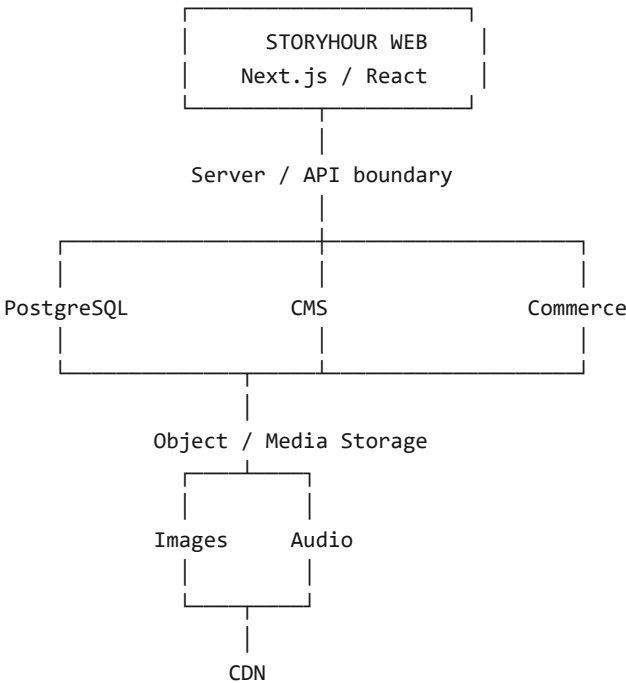
MODULE	MINIMUM CAPABILITIES
Stories	Create, edit, preview, publish, archive.
Chapters / audio	Upload, order, preview, replace.
Categories	Create and manage taxonomy.
Languages	Manage available languages.
Events	Create, schedule, publish, archive.
Journal	Draft, review, publish, archive.
Media	Search and reuse approved media.
Products	Map content to commerce products.

Users / roles	Manage operational access.
SEO	Per-page title, description, image and canonical controls.

Publishing states



11 / Technical architecture



External integrations:
Payments • Email • Analytics • Monitoring

Recommended baseline

LAYER	BASELINE
Web	Next.js + TypeScript
UI	Tailwind CSS + project design tokens
Motion	GSAP and/or Framer Motion where justified
Data	PostgreSQL
Media	S3-compatible object storage + CDN
API	Next.js server/API layer or dedicated Node API
CMS	Headless CMS or custom admin, final choice pending

Commerce	Existing platform/headless integration or approved replacement
Hosting	Vercel or equivalent

The team should avoid building two separate sources of truth for content, orders or user entitlements.

12 / API contract

ID	METHOD	ROUTE	PURPOSE
API-001	GET	/api/stories	Published stories with filters.
API-002	GET	/api/stories/:slug	Single published story.
API-003	GET	/api/categories	Story categories.
API-004	GET	/api/events	Published events.
API-005	GET	/api/events/:slug	Single event.
API-006	GET	/api/journal	Published articles.
API-007	GET	/api/journal/:slug	Single article.
API-008	GET	/api/me/library	Customer entitlements.
API-009	POST	/api/contact	Contact/event enquiry.

API conventions

- Validate at the server boundary.
- Return consistent success and error shapes.
- Paginate collection endpoints.
- Do not expose private media or secrets.
- Authorize every privileged mutation on the server.
- Version breaking API changes.

13 / Authentication & access

ROLE	ACCESS
Visitor	Public content, search, previews, enquiries.
Customer	Own account, orders and entitled content.
Editor	Content creation and publishing within assigned modules.
Administrator	Full operational access.

Authentication provider is a project decision. Whatever is selected, customer access to paid audio must be checked server-side.

14 / Visual system

DESIGN DIRECTION

The intended visual language is contemporary editorial + cinematic storytelling + Indian cultural depth. It should feel considered and premium without becoming a generic “Indian luxury” website.

SYSTEM	RULE
Typography	Use a strong display face for story moments and a highly legible UI/body face.
Colour	Build a restrained palette. Accent colour should be intentional, not applied everywhere.
Imagery	Prefer authentic performance, illustration and atmospheric storytelling imagery over generic stock.
Layout	Large compositions, clear hierarchy, generous negative space.
Cards	Use cards when they aid discovery; do not turn every section into a grid.
Buttons	One clear primary action per section.
Motion	Use movement to establish mood, hierarchy or continuity.
Mobile	Design mobile layouts intentionally, not as collapsed desktop.

Component inventory

Navbar • Footer • Hero • Story Card • Story Grid • Search • Filters • Audio Player • Chapter List • CTA • Button • Badge • Modal • Drawer • Form • Toast • Skeleton • Empty State • Error State • Breadcrumbs

15 / Motion rules

DO	DON'T
Use slow, deliberate reveals for story sections.	Animate every element because the library supports it.
Use image masking for transitions where it improves storytelling.	Create long blocking page transitions.
Keep audio controls responsive during animation.	Let motion delay access to content.
Respect reduced-motion preferences.	Assume mobile users want desktop animation at full intensity.
Measure performance after adding motion.	Treat animation as free.

16 / SEO & content migration

The rebuild must preserve useful search equity. Before launch, crawl the existing site and create a source-to-destination URL map.

TASK	DELIVERABLE
URL inventory	Export of current indexable URLs.
Redirect map	Old URL → new canonical destination.
Metadata	Title/description for every public template.
Structured data	Relevant schema for organisation, articles, breadcrumbs and products where appropriate.
Sitemap	Production XML sitemap.
Robots	Production robots policy.
Media	Optimised filenames, alt text and delivery.

Do not launch until high-value legacy URLs and their redirects have been tested.

17 / Performance & accessibility

AREA	REQUIREMENT
LCP	Target ≤ 2.5s on representative production conditions.
INP	Target ≤ 200ms where practical.
CLS	Target ≤ 0.1.
Images	Responsive formats, compression and appropriate lazy loading.
Fonts	Only required fonts; avoid unnecessary blocking.
Keyboard	All interactive controls usable without a mouse.
Focus	Visible focus state.
Contrast	Accessible contrast for text and controls.
Motion	Reduced-motion fallback.
Forms	Clear labels, validation and recovery.

18 / Analytics

EVENT	WHEN
story_view	Story detail opened.
story_play	Audio starts.
story_progress	Defined listening milestone.
story_complete	Audio finishes.

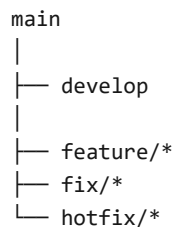
search	Search performed.
filter_used	Catalogue filter applied.
add_to_cart	Product added.
checkout_start	Checkout begins.
purchase	Successful purchase.
event_view	Event detail opened.
event_enquiry	Event enquiry submitted.

The exact analytics provider and consent model are client decisions. Avoid collecting unnecessary personal data.

19 / Security

- HTTPS everywhere.
- Secrets stored outside source control.
- Server-side validation and authorization.
- Rate limiting for authentication and public forms.
- Secure session/cookie configuration.
- Protected media access.
- Restricted admin permissions.
- Dependency and vulnerability monitoring.
- No passwords, payment secrets or private tokens in logs.

20 / Repository & delivery workflow



STEP	RULE
Branch	One feature/fix per branch.
PR	Description, screenshots where relevant, tests, migration notes.
CI	Build + lint + tests must pass.
Review	At least one appropriate reviewer before merge.
Staging	All release candidates tested here.
Production	Only approved, tested builds.

SOURCE OF TRUTH

Requirements in this document should be referenced by ID in GitHub issues, design notes and QA cases. Changes to scope should be recorded rather than silently implemented.

21 / Build sequence

PHASE	OUTPUT
01 — Discovery	Existing-site audit, content inventory, integrations, business decisions.
02 — UX	Sitemap, journeys, wireframes, content model.
03 — Visual design	Design system, responsive pages, motion and audio UI.
04 — Foundation	Repository, environments, CI/CD, routing, tokens, shared components.
05 — Core product	Home, Stories, Story detail, Storyteller, Journal.
06 — Audio	Player, chapters, preview, access control, media pipeline.
07 — Commerce	Products, cart, checkout, payments, orders, entitlements.
08 — CMS	Content creation, media, publishing, permissions.
09 — Events	Experiences, events and enquiries, if confirmed.
10 — Migration + QA	Content, redirects, browser/device, accessibility, performance.
11 — Launch	Production deployment, smoke tests, monitoring, rollback readiness.

22 / Definition of done

A feature is not done when it works on the developer's machine.

CHECK	REQUIRED
Design	Matches approved Figma and responsive rules.
Function	Happy path and failure paths work.
Responsive	Desktop, tablet and mobile checked.
Accessibility	Keyboard, focus, labels and contrast checked.
Performance	No avoidable regressions.
SEO	Implemented where the page is indexable.
Analytics	Relevant events verified.
Security	Access rules and input handling reviewed.
QA	Acceptance criteria passed.
Release	Merged, staged and documented.

23 / Release checklist

Product

- ☐ Homepage
- ☐ Stories
- ☐ Story detail
- ☐ Audio
- ☐ Experiences
- ☐ Events
- ☐ Journal
- ☐ Storyteller
- ☐ Contact

Commerce

- ☐ Shop
- ☐ Cart
- ☐ Checkout
- ☐ Payment
- ☐ Order confirmation
- ☐ Digital entitlement

Platform

- ☐ Auth
- ☐ CMS
- ☐ Database
- ☐ Media storage
- ☐ API
- ☐ Roles

Quality

- ☐ Responsive QA
- ☐ Accessibility
- ☐ SEO
- ☐ Performance
- ☐ Security
- ☐ Cross-browser

Production

- ☐ Domain
- ☐ SSL
- ☐ Analytics

- ☐ Sitemap
- ☐ Robots
- ☐ Redirects
- ☐ Backups
- ☐ Monitoring
- ☐ Rollback

24 / Decisions to close before engineering lock

DECISION	WHY IT BLOCKS
Commerce platform	Defines product/order/customer architecture.
Payment provider	Defines checkout implementation.
Currency + markets	Affects pricing, tax and checkout.
Physical shipping	Determines whether “Free Shipping” remains relevant.
Audio delivery	Download, streaming or both changes infrastructure.
Customer accounts	Determines entitlement and library architecture.
CMS	Determines content workflow.
Event booking	Simple enquiry vs booking/ticketing.
Content inventory	Determines migration and launch scope.
Brand assets & rights	Determines what media can legally be used.
Legal/policy pages	Required before commerce launch.

25 / Working rules for the team

- Do not build permanent architecture around a TBD business decision.
- Do not replace current production data without a tested migration and rollback plan.
- Do not hard-code catalogue content.
- Do not expose protected audio because the frontend button is hidden.
- Do not add animation that has no product purpose.
- Do not treat mobile as an afterthought.
- Do not close a feature without QA and acceptance criteria.
- Do not change approved scope silently. Record the change.

FINAL STANDARD

The finished product should feel like StoryHour, not like a generic ecommerce template with Indian imagery placed on top. The implementation should be scalable enough for the catalogue to grow, simple enough for the content team to operate, and disciplined enough to reach production without rebuilding the foundation halfway through.

Appendix A / Current reference facts

The live homepage currently uses the headline “Stories That Live Beyond Time,” lists three Ramayana audiobook products in Hindi, English and Telugu, and describes StoryHour around cultural storytelling, all-ages content, audio-first listening, expressive performance and cultural preservation. [\[cite2turn0view0\]](#)

The current English Ramayana product is listed at \$84.99, the Hindi product at \$74.99, and the homepage lists the Telugu audiobook at \$64.99. Current product pages also display “Free Shipping.” These are current-site observations and must not be copied into the new production system without business confirmation.

[\[cite2turn0search12turn0search22turn0view0\]](#)

Appendix B / Requirement priority

LEVEL	MEANING
MUST	Required for the agreed release.
SHOULD	Important; can only move with explicit product approval.
MAY	Useful enhancement, not required for initial release.
TBD	Business/client decision required before implementation.